SOCIAL EAGLE
learn. build. operate

WEEK 3 · DAY 2

Install and Verify n8n on Your System

Assignment | learn. build. operate

1. Problem Statement

Everything you build for the rest of this week runs on **n8n**, so today is about getting it installed and proving it works. Install n8n on your own machine, open the editor in your browser, create your account, and run one tiny workflow end to end. Then screenshot the proof.

Tools: n8n, Node.js or Docker, a terminal

2. Requirements

- Install **n8n on your own system**, not the hosted Cloud trial. The point is running it locally.
- Open the editor at `http://localhost:5678` and create the owner account it asks for.
- Confirm the version you are running with `n8n --version` or from the editor.
- Build a **one-node test workflow** and execute it successfully, installing it is not the same as proving it runs.
- Take a screenshot that shows n8n running: the editor open, with your successful execution visible.
- Note where n8n stored its data on your machine; you will want it tomorrow.

> **Think it through**
>
> There is more than one way in: `npx` runs it without installing anything permanently; a global `npm` install gives you a lasting `n8n` command; and Docker keeps it isolated from the rest of your system. Which suits your machine, and what happens to your workflows when you close the terminal?

3. Steps to complete

These are hints, not the full answer. Pick one install route and read what it prints.

Step 1: Check your prerequisites

n8n needs **Node.js 18 or newer** for the npm routes, or Docker for the container route.

```
node --version
npm --version
```

Step 2: Install and start it

```
# Option A - run it without installing
npx n8n

# Option B - install it properly
npm install -g n8n
n8n start

# Option C - Docker
docker run -it --rm -p 5678:5678 \
  -v n8n_data:/home/node/.n8n docker.n8n.io/n8nio/n8n
```

Leave the terminal open, closing it stops n8n. Options A and B keep your data in `~/.n8n`; Option C keeps it in the named volume.

Step 3: Verify it really works

Open `http://localhost:5678`, create the owner account, then add a **Manual Trigger** and one **Edit Fields** node, and click **Execute workflow**. A green tick means you are done.

4. Final output

```
$ npx n8n
Editor is now accessible via:
http://localhost:5678

[browser] n8n editor open, owner account created,
          test workflow executed with a green tick
```

5. What to submit

- A screenshot of the n8n editor running on your machine with a successful execution on screen.
- A screenshot of your terminal showing n8n started and the version you are on.
- Post both in the **community** and share them in **WhatsApp**.